This Bank, That Bank

Lark & Nib's Treasure Quest · Season 4, Episode 7

Nib began arranging the reading mat beneath an old sign with splendid painted curls. Across the landing, a newer note pointed toward a reachable shelf. Lark laid the current landing picture beside both directions. One matched the place where your boat could actually stop.

“That sign has splendid curls,” Nib argued. “This bank has our landing,” Lark replied warmly.

Lark opened an earlier journal page on a flat, dry surface. Nib steadied its lower corner. One familiar word waited for another look.

“Try our earlier word before we start,” Lark invited gently. “You can sound it out or ask for help.”

> **thin**

“In this, that, and then, th uses voice,” Lark modeled clearly. “Compare it with the breathy beginning of thin. The little word the has voiced th too, with a soft weak vowel in this sentence. We'll model the whole word before asking you to read it.”

“Join the parts and check the whole meaning,” Lark invited gently. “You can hear a part again whenever you want.”

On a little practice strip, you could try this, that, then, the. Lark supplied unfamiliar story names herself. Nib waited while you looked right through each word.

“Read this bank on the current note,” Lark invited gently. “Which real landing matches its picture?”

A short passage stayed in view. Lark paired each needed capital with its lowercase form and familiar sound before you began, leaving the sentence meanings for you to discover.

“Read the sentences in order,” Lark invited gently. “Let your finger follow if it helps. When you are ready, use the words to answer our question.”

> **This is the path. The cart is on that path.**

“Where is the cart?” Lark asked gently. “Which sentence tells us?”

Lark kept the passage open so you could point to the part that helped. Nib listened before adding the picture.

Nib moved the portable mat to the bank identified by the current note. Lark fixed a clear updated sign there and marked the old direction as out of date. The reading place now matched the reachable shelf. Moon stayed aboard until its support was ready; choosing a bank had not yet completed the loan.

“Let's keep a written clue,” Lark suggested warmly. “Write this beside our picture. You can look at the example, follow it first, or try your own version. Then reread what you made.”

Lark drew the actual landing on your journal page. Nib admired the older sign's curls one last time, then turned to the book request. The reader had asked for Moon, whatever the prettiest cover might show.